



PHOTO BY MILIND SHELTE

LEADING THE EV PUSH

Amid renewed interest for EVs, the Mahindra Group is doubling down on e-vehicles and is looking to raise the bar on sustainable manufacturing

BY KARAN DHAR

WHEN PRIME MINISTER Narendra Modi urged Indians to use electric vehicles (EVs) to conserve fuel and cut the country's swelling import bill amid the global energy crisis, electric cars made by homegrown automaker Mahindra & Mahindra (M&M) gained further traction.

Government functionaries and others switched to EVs overnight, and that came as a boost to M&M, which has an extensive line-up of premium EVs. This adds to the company's recent outperformance that helped it overtake JSW MG Motor India to become India's second-largest electric carmaker by volume for three consecutive months from March. M&M already leads the EV market in terms of revenue.

It has been recognised with the Special Jury Award in Sustainability Leadership in this year's *BT India's* Most Sustainable Companies.

"While it is still early, we are seeing a surge in interest in EVs especially from central and state governments," Rajesh Jejurikar, Executive Director and CEO (Auto and Farm Sector), tells *Business Today*. "The PM's appeal will further boost the strong shift in consumer behaviour," he says.

M&M also leads the EV race in three-wheelers with its subsidiary Mahindra Last Mile Mobility.

All this has helped it attract marquee global investors including British International Investment, International Finance Corporation and Temasek, among others.

"Sustainability is becoming a key differentiator for corporate reputation. Investors are increasing their scrutiny of OEMs' sustainability actions. Market regulator Sebi through Business Responsibility and Sustainability Reporting is raising non-financial data capture and disclosure